

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Judge blocks deployment

Temporary restraining order bars president from sending federalized troops to any location in Illinois



Illinois Attorney General Kwame Raoul speaks with reporters after a federal judge blocked the Trump administration from deploying National Guard troops to the city on Thursday at the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse in Chicago. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

By Jason Meisner, Jonathan Bullington and Dan Petrella
Chicago Tribune

A federal judge in Chicago on Thursday blocked the Trump administration from deploying National Guard troops to the city and state as part of its ongoing immigration enforcement push, saying she had no faith in the government's claims of out-of-control violence and that it was federal agents who started it by aggressively targeting protesters with tear gas and militaristic tactics.

The ruling by U.S. District Judge April Perry is the latest setback for President Donald Trump, who has claimed ongoing violence and clashes between protesters and immigration agents in Chicago and other U.S. cities justified sending federalized troops onto the streets as a security force, even as local and state officials accused the president of manufacturing a crisis to justify unnecessary — and unprecedented — force.

The temporary restraining order issued by Perry, which took effect immediately, bars the president from deploying federalized National Guard troops from any state to any location in Illinois. A written ruling would be issued Friday, she said.

Gov. JB Pritzker cheered the ruling in a statement on social media, writing, “Donald Trump is not a king — and his administration is not above the law.”

Perry’s ruling “confirmed what we all know: there is no credible evidence of a rebellion in the state of Illinois. And no place for the National Guard in the streets of American cities like Chicago,” Pritzker wrote.

A spokesperson for Trump, meanwhile, said the judge got it wrong — and there will be an appeal.

“Amidst ongoing violent riots and lawlessness, that local leaders like Pritzker have refused to step in to quell, President Trump has exercised his lawful authority to protect federal officers and assets,” White House spokeswoman Abigail Jackson wrote in an emailed statement. “President Trump will not turn a blind eye to the lawlessness plaguing American cities and we expect to be vindicated by a higher court.”

It was not immediately clear what would happen with National Guard troops already working

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National Guard ‘employed’ in the area

No ‘official reports’ of activity; unclear if troops will remain

By Jeremy Gorner, Caroline Kubzansky, Gregory Royal Pratt and Tess Kenny
Chicago Tribune

National Guard members were spotted early Thursday at an Immigration and Customs Enforcement detention center in Broadview, hours before a federal judge blocked President Donald Trump’s administration from deploying the troops in Illinois.

The Texas National Guard, which arrived in the area earlier this week, had been expected throughout the Chicago area, but were rarely in plain view at Broadview. Those troops were federalized by the Trump administration following a series of intense

confrontations between protesters and federal immigration enforcement officers taking part in “Operation Midway Blitz,” the mass deportation mission being carried out in Chicago and the suburbs.

It was unclear whether the troops will remain at the federal property in Broadview following the ruling from U.S. District Judge April Perry, who said that National Guard troops are “not trained in de-escalation or other extremely important law enforcement functions that would help to quell these problems,” and that allowing troops to come into Illinois “will only add fuel to the fire that the defendants themselves have started.”

The Department of Defense did not immediately respond to requests for comment after the court hearing.

A spokesman for U.S. North-

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A “No Troops in Our Streets” sign is posted as agents watch protesters at the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement facility in Broadview on Thursday. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

IN CHICAGOLAND: Prosecutors drop charges against Oak Park man with intellectual disabilities arrested at Broadview protest.

■ Kristi Noem says Homeland Security is “purchasing more buildings in Chicago.” **Stories on Page 3**

Preckwinkle unveils \$10.1B budget, which taps reserves

Election year proposal doesn’t include any new taxes, fines or fees

By A.D. Quig
Chicago Tribune

Cook County Board President Toni Preckwinkle publicly unveiled her \$10.1 billion 2026 budget Thursday, a slight increase from last year’s proposal that also girds against potential federal cuts and a pending lawsuit that could upend how the county funds its public safety offices.

Sticking with a now yearslong trend, Preckwinkle’s proposal does not include any new taxes, fines or fees, and eliminates a projected \$211 million shortfall thanks in large part to better-



Cook County Board President Toni Preckwinkle presides over a board meeting after giving her 2026 budget speech in the Cook County boardroom on Thursday. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

than-expected revenues.

While she said the county is well-suited for now, federal cuts are sure to eventually hit Cook County Health, which runs a Medicaid managed care program and hospitals and clinics that treat patients regardless of their ability to pay. Expanded federal support for safety net hospitals and insurance coverage have brought the

county’s hospital system into the black over the last decade, but the tides could be turning, Preckwinkle and CCH leadership warned.

In her budget speech, Preckwinkle took several shots at President Donald Trump. She said his immigration raids, efforts to cut Medicaid and other local

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Sides to exchange hostages, prisoners

Hamas says Israel to release 2,000 as pause in war nears

By Samy Magdy, Melanie Lidman and Waafa Shurafa
Associated Press

CAIRO — Israel’s Cabinet has approved the “outline” of a deal to release hostages held by Hamas, Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu’s office said early Friday, as top Israeli officials debated a tentative deal to pause the devastating two-year war with Hamas.

The approval is a key step in implementing a ceasefire and the exchange of hostages for Palestinian prisoners brokered by U.S. President Donald Trump. The brief statement focused on the hostage release and made

no mention of the other parts of Trump’s plan for ending the war.

The broader ceasefire plan advanced by Trump’s administration included many unanswered questions, such as whether and how Hamas will disarm and who will govern Gaza. But the sides appeared closer than they have been in months to ending a war that has killed tens of thousands of Palestinians, reduced much of Gaza to rubble, brought famine to parts of the territory and left dozens of hostages, living and dead, in Gaza.

Even with the agreement hanging in the balance, Israeli strikes continued, with explosions seen Thursday in northern Gaza. At least 11 dead Palestinians and another 49 who were wounded arrived at hospitals over the previous 24 hours,

Turn to Deal, Page 6

Mistrust fueling shutdown

Senators labored Thursday to find a way forward but found themselves struggling to overcome a lack of trust between the two parties. **Nation & World**

‘Genius grant’ winners

This year, 22 people — including a Chicago photographer — had their lives changed when they were awarded MacArthur Fellowships on Wednesday. **A+E**

The true star of the show

Wrigley Field is a special place. When it’s as electric as it has been during these playoffs, the atmosphere is hard to beat. **Paul Sullivan in Chicago Sports**

TODAY’S WEATHER



High **68** Low **51**

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 14

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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